OBSERVATORY ONLINE



PLAYER'S MANUAL

Light the fire. Shape the shadow. Borrow six seconds.

FIRE ✦ SHADOW ✦ TIME

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PLAY IN YOUR BROWSER · **adil-infosec.github.io/SIX-SECONDS-OF-SUN**

Getting Started

At the sixth hour of an endless eclipse, the great solar observatory has gone dark. You are the last Lightkeeper. Relight its chambers and restart the solar engine before the darkness becomes permanent.

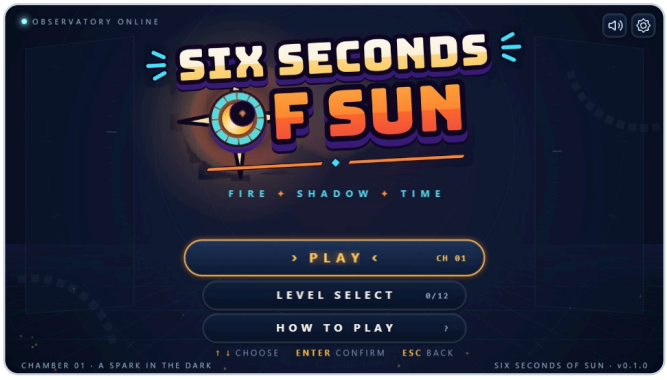
WHAT YOU NEED

- A desktop or laptop browser: **Chrome, Edge or Firefox**.
- A keyboard. A mouse is optional (menus can be clicked).
- Speakers or headphones: the soundscape tells you a lot.
- About **10–15 minutes** for the six campaign chambers.

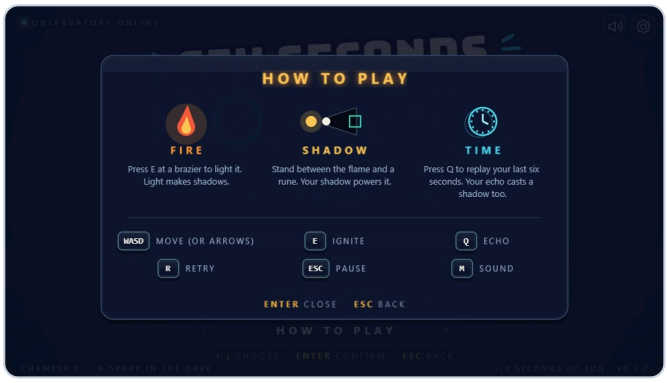
STARTING A GAME

1. Open **adil-infosec.github.io/SIX-SECONDS-OF-SUN**.
2. On the title screen, choose **PLAY**. It continues from the next chamber you have not cleared yet.
3. **LEVEL SELECT** lets you replay any unlocked chamber; **HOW TO PLAY** shows a one-screen summary.

> **SOUND** Browsers only allow sound after your first key press or click, so the music begins as soon as you touch the game.



The title screen. Top right: sound on/off and settings.



HOW TO PLAY: the three rules and every key, on one screen.

CONTROLS

IN A CHAMBER

`W` `A` `S` `D` **or arrows**	Move in 8 directions
`E`	Light the brazier you are standing next to
`Q`	Release your 6-second echo (from chamber 3)
`R`	Restart the chamber instantly
`Esc`	Pause: Resume · Restart · Chambers
`M`	Sound on / off

IN MENUS

`↑` `↓` **or** `W` `S`	Choose a button
`Enter` / `Space`	Confirm
`Esc`	Back / close a panel
`Q` / `E`	Chamber list: switch Campaign / Bonus page
`V`	Screen shake on / off
Mouse	Hover to select, click to confirm

Fire, Shadow and Time

Every chamber is a sealed room with an exit gate. Open the gate, step into the portal behind it, and the chamber is cleared. Three ideas open every gate, and they work as one chain.

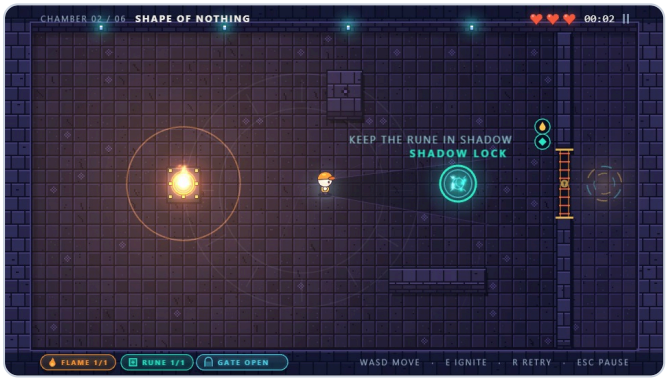
FIRE
Stand next to a brazier and press **E**. The main beacon floods the room with light. No fire, no shadows.

SHADOW
Your body blocks the light and throws a shadow straight away from the flame. Put that shadow on a rune to power it.

TIME
Press **Q** and your last six seconds of movement become a looping cyan echo. Its shadow powers runes too.

CASTING A SHADOW

- Your shadow always points **away from the lit beacon**. To aim it, stand between the flame and the target.
- It starts at your feet and widens with distance. Stepping toward or away from the flame slides it along the floor.
- Hold the shadow on a rune: its ring fills in under half a second, then the rune lights up (**SHADOW LOCK**).



Chamber 2: standing between the flame and the rune locks it.

YOUR ECHO (Q)

- The brace on your wrist remembers your last **6 seconds**. The **MEMORY** ring at the top of the screen fills as you move; with at least 1 second stored it glows cyan and Q is ready.
- The echo replays that path forever. To make it stand still, stand still for six seconds before you press Q.
- Its shadow works exactly like yours, and standing **in your echo's shadow** protects you from fire.
- Pressing Q again replaces the old echo. The echo cannot light braziers or leave the room.



Chamber 3: the echo holds the rune in shadow while you walk out.

RUNES AND GATES

Latching rune	Solid ring. Once powered it stays powered.
Continuous rune	Dashed outer ring. Only powered while a shadow is on it: hold it yourself, or leave your echo there.
The gate	Icons beside it show what it needs (flames, relays, runes). It opens when all are met and closes again if one is lost, unless you are standing in the doorway.

The Screen, Hazards & Stars

READING THE SCREEN

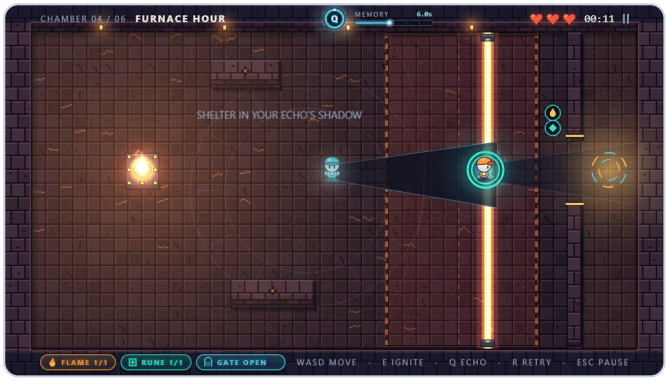
Top left	Chamber number and name.
Top centre	**MEMORY** ring around the Q key and seconds stored; the bar beside it shows where your echo is in its six-second loop.
Top right	Hearts, the chamber clock (it starts when you first move) and the pause sign.
Bottom left	Goal badges: **FLAME** lit, **RUNE** powered, **GATE** locked / open. They light up as you complete them.
In the room	An `E` key appears over a brazier you can light; short hints mark what to try next.

FIRE SCANNERS

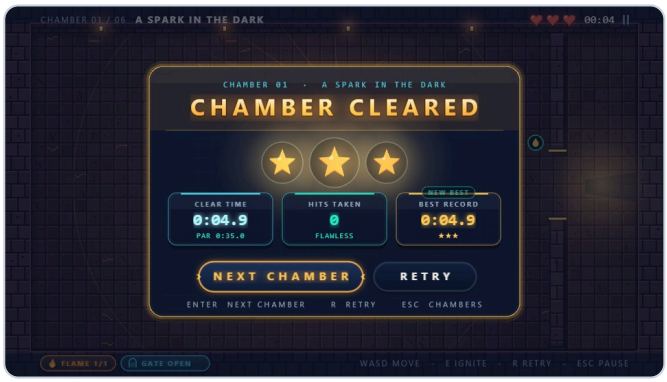
- Burning bands sweep back and forth across striped hazard lanes.
- A **dashed line** shows where the band will be a moment later, and a red ring flashes around you just before it would touch you.
- Cross when the band is far away, or stand **inside your echo's shadow**: the fire cannot burn you there.

HEARTS AND CHECKPOINTS

- You have **3 hearts**. A burn costs one, and you reappear at the last checkpoint you touched (or the start), protected for one second.
- Lose all three and the chamber is **EXTINGUISHED**: it restarts by itself. Press `R` any time to restart sooner.



Chamber 4: the band passes right over the keeper, who is safe inside the echo's shadow.



The clear screen: stars, time against par, hits and your best record.

STARS

RATING	HOW TO EARN IT
★★★	Clear within the chamber's **par time** with **no hits**.
★★	Clear within **1.5 × par** with at most **one hit**.
★	Any clear.

Your best time and best stars are kept for every chamber; beating either shows **NEW BEST**.

The Chambers

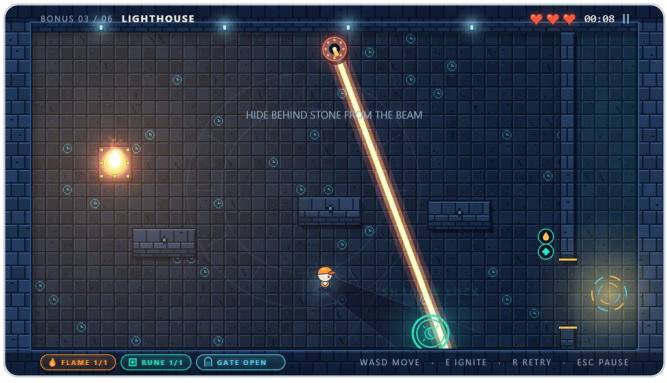
Six campaign chambers teach one idea each, then combine them. Clearing chamber 6 plays the sunrise and opens six bonus chambers with new mechanics.

CAMPAIGN

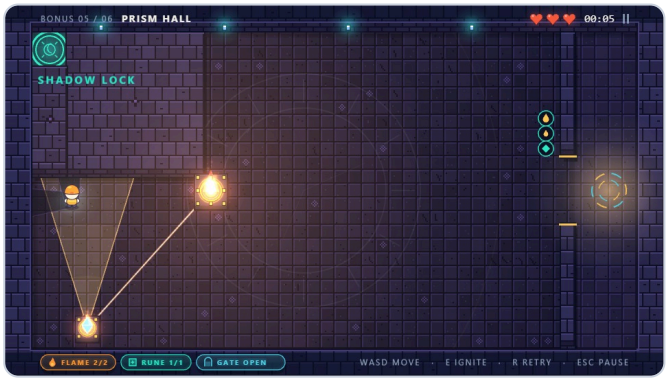
#	CHAMBER	PAR	WHAT IT TEACHES
01	**A Spark in the Dark** FIRE	0:35	Light the beacon with E; the gate opens.
02	**Shape of Nothing** SHADOW	1:00	Stand between flame and rune to lock it with your shadow.
03	**The Other You** TIME	1:20	One keeper cannot hold the rune and leave: let your echo hold it.
04	**Furnace Hour** FIRE	1:35	Park the echo on the rune, then shelter in its shade from the scanner.
05	**Ashes and Angles** SHADOW	1:50	Light a relay too, and match an angled shadow line.
06	**Six Seconds of Sun** SUN	2:25	The finale: sun core, two relays, two scanner lanes and your echo.

BONUS CHAMBERS

07	**Twin Seals**	Two seals that charge only while **one shadow covers both** (dotted link).
08	**Shifting Stones**	Sliding pillars **cut your shadow short**; charge in the gaps.
09	**Lighthouse**	A fire beam turns full circle; it stops at stone, so **hide behind blocks**.
10	**Clockwork Order**	Rune A holds for **3 seconds** (amber ring); power B before it runs out.
11	**Prism Hall**	Light the flame, then the **prism**: its cone throws a second shadow at a new angle.
12	**Echo Gauntlet**	Two fast fire lanes: park an echo before each and cross in its shade.



Bonus 03: the beam stops at the block; the keeper waits in its lee.



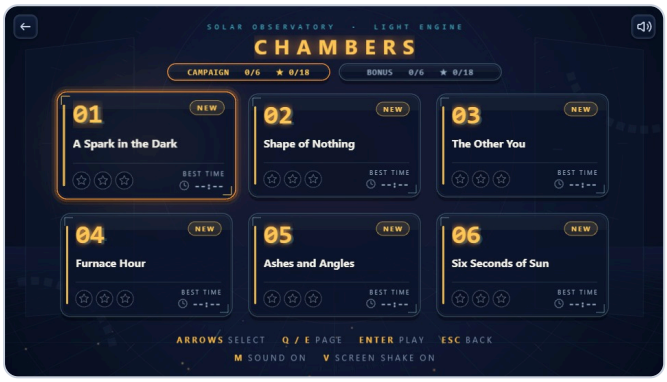
Bonus 05: the prism's cone reaches the sealed corner rune.

TIP Stuck? Watch which way your shadow points, then walk along the line from the flame through the rune. The right spot is always on that line.

Menus, Saving & Help

CHAMBER LIST

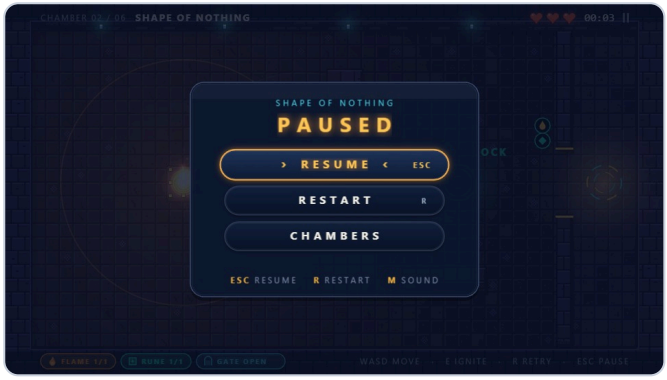
- Cards show each chamber's number, best stars and best time. Locked chambers are dimmed.
- Two pages: **CAMPAIGN** and **BONUS**. Switch with `Q` / `E`, or click the tabs.
- The arrow at top left returns to the title; the speaker toggles sound.



The chamber list, campaign page.

PAUSE & SETTINGS

- `Esc` pauses: **RESUME**, **RESTART** or back to **CHAMBERS**.
- The game also pauses itself if the window loses focus, so nothing can hurt you while you are away.
- The gear on the title screen opens **Settings**: sound and screen shake.



The pause card.

SAVING

- Progress saves automatically in your browser after every clear: unlocked chambers, best times, stars and settings.
- It is stored on this computer, in this browser. Clearing the browser's site data resets it.

TROUBLESHOOTING

No sound	Press any key or click the game once; check `M` and the speaker icon; make sure the browser tab is not muted.
Blank or black screen	The game switches to its Canvas renderer automatically if WebGL fails. You can force it by adding **?renderer=canvas** to the address.
Choppy movement	Close other heavy tabs, and turn on hardware acceleration in the browser settings.
Game paused by itself	The window lost focus. Click the game and press `Esc` or choose RESUME.
Stuck in a puzzle	Press `R` to restart instantly; re-read the hint in the room; check the goal badges at bottom left.

QUICK QUESTIONS

Why is Q not working? The echo unlocks in chamber 3, needs at least one second of memory, and has a short cooldown after each use.

Why won't the brazier light? Stand right next to it, until the `E` key appears above it. A prism takes light only after the main beacon is lit.

My shadow is on the rune but nothing happens. Hold it there a little longer, and check that the beacon is lit: no fire, no shadow.